Itai Shapira

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Education

Harvard University, Cambridge, MA — *Sept 2022 – Present*
PhD in Computer Science (Expected graduation: 12/26)

- Advisor: Ariel D. Procaccia
- Research in AI alignment, optimization for deep learning and computational social choice.

Harvard University, Cambridge, MA — *2022 – 2024*
Master of Science in Computer Science

- Cumulative GPA: 4.0/4.0

The Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Jerusalem, Israel — *2016 – 2019*
Bachelor of Science in Mathematics and Economics

- Summa Cum Laude (Ranked first in class)
- Cumulative GPA: 99/100

Experience

Two Sigma, New York, NY — *Jun 2025 – Aug 2025*
Quantitative Research Internship

WorldQuant, Tel Aviv — *Nov 2018 – Sep 2022*
Senior Quantitative Researcher

Publications

Notation:
(α) authors listed alphabetically by last name (order not indicative of contribution).
(r) order is randomized among the equal-contribution lead authors (marked with †).

[11] How RLHF Amplifies Sycophancy — 2026
Itai Shapira, Gerdus Benadè, Ariel D. Procaccia
[Arxiv] *ICML 2026*

[10] Robust AI Evaluation through Maximal Lotteries — 2026
(r) Hadi Khalaf, Serena Lutong Wang†, Daniel Halpern†, *Itai Shapira*†, Flavio P. Calmon, Ariel D. Procaccia
[Arxiv] *ICML 2026*

[8] Incentives in Federated Learning with Heterogeneous Agents — 2026
(α) Ariel D. Procaccia, Han Shao, *Itai Shapira*
[Arxiv] *ICLR 2026*

[9] Pairwise Calibrated Rewards for Pluralistic Alignment — 2025
(α) Daniel Halpern, Evi Micha, Ariel D. Procaccia, *Itai Shapira*
[Arxiv] *NeurIPS 2025*

[7] SOAP: Improving and Stabilizing Shampoo using Adam — 2025
Nikhil Vyas†, Depen Morwani†, Rosie Zhao, *Itai Shapira*, David Brandfonbrener, Lucas Janson, Sham Kakade
[Arxiv] *ICLR 2025*

[6] A New Perspective on Shampoo's Preconditioner 2025

(r) Depen Morwani[†], *Itai Shapira*[†], Nikhil Vyas[†], Eran Malach, Sham Kakade, Lucas Janson

[Arxiv] *ICLR 2025*

[5] Axioms for AI Alignment from Human Feedback 2024

(α) Luise Ge, Daniel Halpern, Evi Micha, Ariel D. Procaccia, *Itai Shapira*, Yevgeniy Vorobeychik, Junlin Wu

[Arxiv] *NeurIPS 2024* (**Spotlight, 2.1% of submissions**)

[4] Learning Social Welfare Functions 2024

(r) Kanad Shrikar Pardeshi[†], *Itai Shapira*[†], Ariel D. Procaccia, Aarti Singh

[Arxiv] *NeurIPS 2024* (**Spotlight, 2.1% of submissions**)

[3] Bias Detection Via Signaling 2024

(α) Yiling Chen, Tao Lin, Ariel D. Procaccia, Aaditya Ramdas, *Itai Shapira*

[Arxiv] *NeurIPS 2024*

[2] Generative Social Choice 2024

(α) Sara Fish, Paul Gölz, David C. Parkes, Ariel D. Procaccia, Gili Rusak, *Itai Shapira*, Manuel Wüthrich

[Arxiv] [OpenAI Blog] *EC 2024*

[1] Optimal Engagement-Diversity Tradeoffs in Social Media 2024

(α) Fabian Baumann, Daniel Halpern, Ariel D. Procaccia, Iyad Rahwan, *Itai Shapira*, Manuel Wüthrich

[ACM] [Arxiv] *2024 ACM Web Conference*

Selected Honors & Awards

JPMorgan Chase PhD Fellowship (Research Award), 2025.
Nicole A. Chen and Karina A. Chen Graduate Student Research Fellowship, Harvard University, 2023.

CEO's Circle Excellence Award, WorldQuant, 2021.

Rector's List, The Hebrew University of Jerusalem, 2019. Top 1% of students.

Dean's Award, The Hebrew University of Jerusalem, 2017, 2018, 2019.

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, C++
ML / Data: PyTorch, TensorFlow or JAX
Systems: Linux, Git, Slurm, HPC clusters, Docker